ENTREPRENEURIAL MINDSET CHALLENGE — DIGITAL POSTER

Building My Own Solution: Three Attempts to Create a Personal Fitness & Wellness Tracker That Actually Sticks

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Initiative | Resourcefulness | Resilience

Entrepreneurial Mindset Traits & My Challenge

Initiative
Instead of downloading another app that I would abandon in a week, I decided to build my own tool from scratch—taking action on a problem I actually cared about solving for myself.

Resourcefulness
I had to learn and wire together technologies I had never used before—React, Supabase, Tailwind, deployment pipelines—with no one guiding me step-by-step.

Resilience
Each version of the app failed to change my behaviour in the way I hoped. I had to keep iterating on both the tool and my own habits without giving up.

The Challenge
Build a personal fitness and wellness tracking app from scratch and use it consistently for two weeks to measurably improve my daily routine—workouts, meals, and habits.

ATTEMPT 1 — ATTEMPT 2 — ATTEMPT 3 → GROWTH

Attempt 1: The Over-Engineered Start

TRAITS TARGETED

Initiative, resourcefulness

GOAL

Build a complete fitness planner app and use it daily for one week to track workouts, meals, and habits.

WHAT I PLANNED

Design every screen first—splash, onboarding, dashboard, workout detail, meal plans, habit tracker, progress, settings—then build them all before starting to use the app.

WHAT ACTUALLY HAPPENED

Spent the entire first week designing and building the UI. Created beautiful screens with animations and navigation, but everything was hardcoded—static mock data, no real tracking, no persistence. When I tried to "use" it on day 7, there was nothing to actually log. The data reset every time I refreshed. I abandoned it after two days of pretending.

OUTCOME

Failure. A good-looking prototype with zero real functionality. I never actually tracked a single workout or meal. The tool was a shell.

> **Felt:** Frustrated and honestly a bit foolish. I had spent all my energy making something look good instead of making it work. It felt like I was avoiding the hard part—actually committing to the routine.

Attempt 2: Making It Real

GOAL (SAME)

Use the app daily for one full week with real data tracking—every workout, every meal, every habit logged.

WHAT I PLANNED

Add a real database (Supabase), authentication, and data persistence. Strip back the UI where needed. Focus on making the core loop work: log, save, review.

WHAT ACTUALLY HAPPENED

Wired up Supabase for auth and data storage. Rebuilt every screen to read/write real data. Created database tables, row-level security, and seeded my account with starter habits. Started using it daily. The first three days went well—I logged workouts and meals consistently. But by day 4, I was only logging workouts. By day 6, I opened the app, saw flat numbers on the dashboard with no sense of progress, and closed it. The app tracked data but gave me nothing back—no trends, no streaks, no feedback.

OUTCOME

Partial success. Real data flowed, I used it for 6 days, but engagement dropped sharply. Logging felt like a chore with no reward.

> **Felt:** Encouraged that the tech worked but deflated that I still couldn't sustain the habit. The irony of building a habit tracker I couldn't stick with was not lost on me.

> **Learned:** Data capture alone does not drive behaviour change. A tool needs a feedback

Attempt 3: The Feedback Loop

GOAL (SAME, EXTENDED)

Use the app consistently for a full two weeks. The measure of success: complete at least 60% of daily habits and log all workouts/meals for 12 out of 14 days.

WHAT I PLANNED

Build a rich progress dashboard with daily bar charts, week-over-week comparisons, per-habit streaks, nutrition trends, and a weekly check-in for self-reflection. Make the app reward consistency visually.

WHAT ACTUALLY HAPPENED

Rebuilt the Progress screen entirely: 14-day habit chart, calorie/protein trends, streak counters, best-day highlights, and a weekly reflection form. Deployed it live. Started the two-week run. The difference was immediate—seeing a bar chart fill up made me want to keep the streak going. I wrote honest weekly reflections about what went well and what was hard. Had a rough Saturday where I only hit 2 of 6 habits, but the data showed me bouncing back on Sunday. By day 14, I had logged every workout, most meals, and averaged 72% habit completion, up from about 58% in week 1.

OUTCOME

Meaningful progress. Completed the two-week stretch. Habit completion improved week-over-week. The tool became something I genuinely opened every morning. Not perfect—but sustained.

> **Felt:** Proud—not because the app was perfect, but because I had built something that